

Welcome

Getting Started with AI

PRESENTER:

Garth Tuck

Workshop Overview + Housekeeping

BY THE END, YOU WILL:

- Understand what generative AI is and where it already shows up
- Practice writing and improving prompts on your phone
- Learn when to verify, slow down, and protect your privacy
- Leave with one real task to try this week

3 X 1-HOUR SESSIONS:

- **Session 1:** Foundations, safety, and privacy
- **Session 2:** Prompting, phone demos, and guided practice
- **Session 3:** Everyday workflows and your action plan

WORKSHOP ENVIRONMENT

- Open, inclusive, and curiosity-driven
- Questions and help are welcome at any time

HOUSEKEEPING

- Wi-Fi: We have none in the building yet
- Activities are designed for use on your phone
- Pair up if you don't have a device or account
- Raise your hand anytime if you need help

Session 1

Foundations: What AI is + how to use it safely

Session 1 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Welcome + quick intros (5)
- AI in daily life (10)
- Core vocabulary (10)
- Why AI feels different now (10)
- What ChatGPT is / isn't (10)
- Privacy + safety basics (10)
- Wrap + prep for Session 2 (5)

AI in our world

Where do you think AI might already be helping you in daily life—without you even realizing it?

A few examples include:

 **Photo Tagging & Face Recognition** Your phone or social media app automatically groups your photos by faces or places—powered by AI.

 **Search Suggestions** As you type, search engines guess what you mean based on past searches and trends—thank AI for that.

 **GPS & Maps** AI predicts traffic, suggests faster routes, and updates real-time arrival times.

 **Streaming Recommendations** Netflix, YouTube, Spotify, etc., use AI to suggest shows or songs based on what you've watched or listened to.

 **Voice Assistants** Siri, Alexa, and Google Assistant recognize speech, interpret commands, and even hold mini conversations.

 **Autocorrect & Smart Text Prediction** Your phone suggests the next word or fixes typos as you type—that's AI anticipating your intent.

Common AI Vocabulary

- **AI (Artificial Intelligence)**

A computer system that can perform tasks usually requiring human intelligence (like understanding language or recognizing images).

- **ML (Machine Learning)**

A type of AI where computers learn from data and improve over time without being explicitly programmed.

- **GPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformer)**

A large language model trained on tons of text to predict and generate human-like responses.

- **LLM (Large Language Model)**

A type of AI trained on massive text data to understand and generate human language.

- **Token**

A piece of a word or character that the AI processes; for example, “chatting” might be split into “chat” and “ting”.

- **Prompt**

The input or question you give to an AI—what you type to start the conversation.

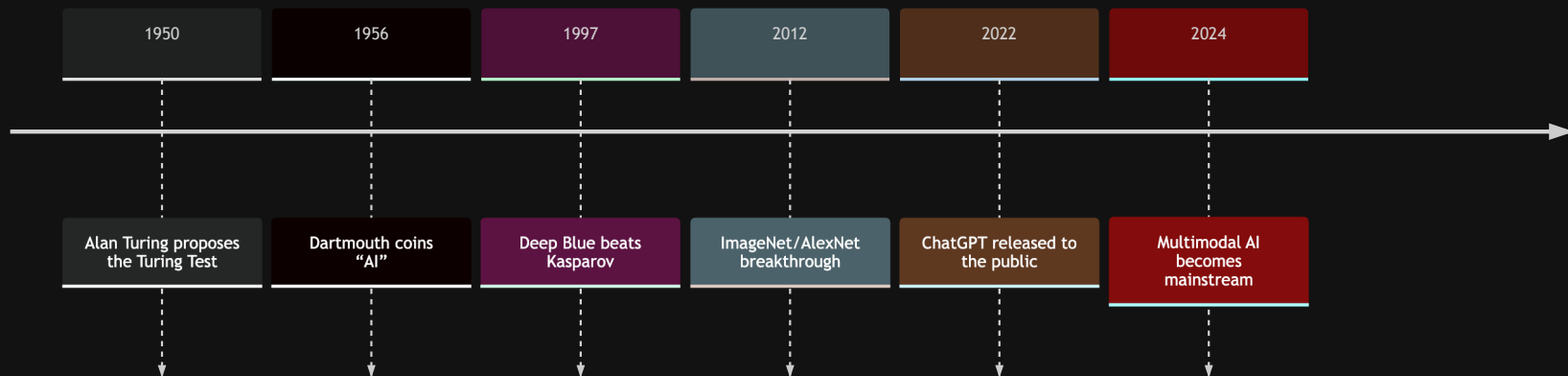
- **Training Data**

The information (usually lots of text) used to teach the AI how to understand and respond.

- **Inference**

The process of the AI generating a response based on your input—it’s “thinking” time for the model.

Moments That Matter (AI)



- AI is not brand new.
- What changed recently is **access**: better tools, lower cost, and easier use on phones and laptops.
- For this workshop, the key date is **2022** when conversational AI became easy for the public to try.

Why AI Feels Different Now

- **You can talk to it naturally**

It feels more like messaging a helper than programming a machine Conversational Demo

- **It works on the devices people already own**

Most people can try it on a phone in minutes.

- **It can handle more than plain text**

Some tools can work with voice, images, files, and web results.

- **It is built into more apps and services**

Search, writing help, photo tools, and assistants now include AI features.

- **The quality can be surprisingly good**

That makes it useful, but also easy to trust too quickly.

- **Your judgment still matters**

Useful does not mean accurate, fair, private, or appropriate.

What AI Chat Is and Isn't

What AI chat is good at

- **Drafting and rewriting** → Messages, emails, posts, reminders, and first drafts.
- **Summarizing and organizing** → Turns long text into bullet points, checklists, or short summaries.
- **Planning and brainstorming** → Helps with errands, meal plans, travel ideas, and next steps.
- **Explaining concepts** → Breaks down unfamiliar topics in plain language.
- **Translating and adapting tone** → Rewrites for clearer, friendlier, shorter, or simpler communication.

Limits and cautions

- **Can be wrong while sounding confident** → Always verify important facts.
- **Not a replacement for experts** → Medical, legal, and financial decisions need trusted sources.
- **May miss local or recent details** → Prices, policies, events, and deadlines can change quickly.
- **Does not know your life unless you tell it** → Missing context leads to generic or off-base answers.
- **Bias and blind spots exist** → Double-check tone, assumptions, and fairness.

Privacy & Safety Basics

- **Do not paste private, financial, medical, or account information.**
- **Remove names, IDs, addresses, account numbers, and passwords.**
- **Get consent before including someone else's messages, photo, or personal details.**
- **On a phone, check screenshots and photos carefully** before uploading anything.
- **Use summaries or excerpts instead of full documents whenever possible.**
- **Review the tool's privacy settings** and opt out of training use if that matters for your situation.
- **Remember:** "Anonymous" is not always anonymous if the situation is very specific.
- **When in doubt, leave it out** and ask in a more general way.

Safer Prompt Example

- **Too much:**

"Summarize this email from my child's teacher. Her name is ____ and our phone number is ____."

- **Safer:**

"Summarize this school message in three bullets. Remove names and personal details. Tell me if there is any action item or deadline."

- **Better habit:**

Share only the part you need help with, not the whole thread.

Session 1 Wrap

One takeaway: What surprised you most about AI today?

One caution: What will you *avoid* sharing with AI tools?

Session 2

Prompting + Practice: getting consistently useful results

Session 2 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Quick recap (5)
- One phone demo from start to finish (10)
- What makes a prompt useful (10)
- Prompt patterns (15)
- Guided phone practice (15)
- Share-outs + Q&A (5)
- Take-home task (last 5)

Everyday Tasks That Work Well on a Phone

-  **Write or rewrite a message**
Ask for a text, email, follow-up, or reminder in a specific tone.
-  **Plan something practical**
Organize errands, meals, trips, study time, or a busy week.
-  **Understand something faster**
Get a plain-language explanation, a summary, or a short quiz.
-  **Translate or simplify**
Rewrite for a different audience, reading level, or language.
-  **Turn a messy idea into a checklist**
Great for starting when you are stuck or overwhelmed.
-  **Still verify before acting**
Helpful first draft, not a final answer.

Live Demo Flow

Start with a real task

Ask in a simple, natural sentence

Add missing details

Ask for a better format

Check the result before you use it

EXAMPLE PHONE TASK

"Write a short text to reschedule my dentist appointment for next week."

Then improve it by adding tone, timing, and word limit.

Pick a Starter Task



Message someone

Reschedule, follow up, thank someone, or ask for help.



Plan your day or week

Ask for a simple schedule that fits your real constraints.



Plan meals or groceries

Use ingredients you already have and a budget you can afford.



Explain something clearly

Ask for a plain-language explanation with examples.



Brainstorm options

Gifts, events, side projects, or questions to ask before a decision.



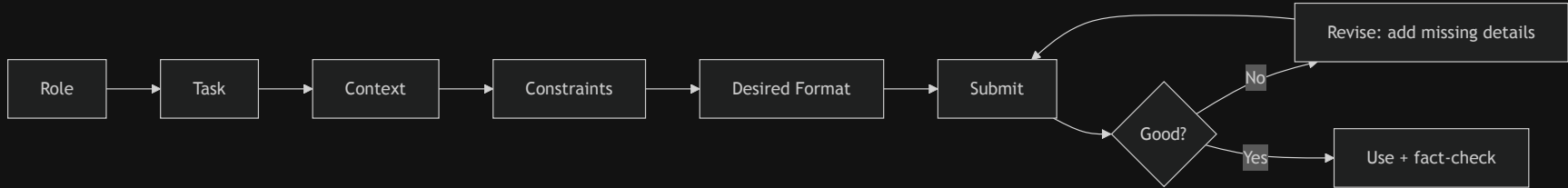
Translate or adapt

Change language, tone, length, or reading level.

When the First Answer Misses

- Add **context**: who, what, where, why
- Add **constraints**: budget, time, tone, word count
- Add **format**: text message, bullets, checklist, table
- Add **audience**: friend, coworker, parent, student, customer
- Ask for **another version** instead of starting over

How to write a good prompt



- **Be specific**

"Write a short text asking to reschedule my appointment" works better than "Help me write something."

- **Use natural language**

You do not need special commands. Just describe the task like you would to a helpful assistant.

- **Set the tone**

Say if you want it friendly, professional, calm, short, direct, or simple.

- **Give constraints**

Include details like audience, deadline, budget, or maximum length.

Prompt Engineering

✗ Poor Prompt

"Write a text to my landlord."

👍 A little better

"Write a polite text to my landlord asking when the dishwasher will be fixed."

🎓 Pro-Level

"Write a short, polite text to my landlord, Jordan.

The dishwasher has not worked since Monday.

I already reported it once.

Ask for an update and suggest a repair window after 5 p.m.

Keep it under 70 words and sound calm, not angry."

Prompt Ideas You Can Try Right Now

✉ Write a polite message to reschedule my dentist appointment.

👨‍🍳 Give me 3 simple dinners from these ingredients: [list].

🧠 Explain what a deductible is in plain language.

📅 Plan a low-cost day trip near [my city] under [\$ amount].

📝 Turn these messy notes into a checklist: [paste notes].

🌐 Translate this text into [language] and keep it friendly.

Group Activity - Try It on Your Phone

- **Timebox: 10 minutes**

- Open your AI app or mobile browser
- Pick **one real task** from the previous slide
- Start with a simple prompt
- Improve it by adding:
 - context
 - constraints
 - desired format
- Save your best version with a screenshot or note
- Pair up if you need a device or account

SHARE BACK

- What task did you choose?
- What changed when you improved the prompt?
- What part of the answer still needed your judgment?

Take-Home Task

GOAL (20–30 MINUTES)

Pick one real task you do at work, school, home, church, or in your community and use AI to improve it.

Choose one:

- Draft an email/message
- Plan a week or event
- Learn something (explain + quiz me)
- Create something useful (recipe, outline, checklist, flyer text)

WHAT TO BRING BACK

- Your **best prompt**
- The **best AI output** or a screenshot
- **2 improvements** you made
- One thing you **still had to check or fix**

Session 3

Apply + Plan: workflows, tools, and your personal action plan

Session 3 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Share homework wins + lessons (15)
- A few practical workflows (15)
- Choosing the right tool for the job (10)
- Optional phone features (10)
- Personal “AI starter kit” plan (5)
- Q&A + next steps (5)

Homework Share-Out

Share with the group:

- Your best prompt
- The most useful output you got
- One thing you changed to improve the result
- What surprised you — or what didn't work?

Practical Workflows: AI in Action

■ MESSAGE WORKFLOW

Draft — "Write a short follow-up text after today's meeting."

Refine — "Make it warmer and cut it to 60 words."

Verify — Check tone, names, dates, and next steps.

■ PLANNING WORKFLOW

Brainstorm — "Give me 8 ways to make weeknights less rushed."

Filter — "Pick the 3 easiest for a busy household."

Expand — "Turn those into a simple plan for this week."

🔍 RESEARCH WORKFLOW

Ask — "Explain [topic] in simple terms."

Clarify — "What are the main options, pros, and cons?"

Verify — Confirm key facts with a trusted source or local policy.

🧠 THE GOLDEN RULE

AI gives you a **first draft**, not a final answer.
You bring the judgment, context, and verification.

Choose the Right Tool for the Job

- **General chat tools** are good for drafting, explaining, brainstorming, and planning.
- **Research-focused tools** are better when you want links or cited sources.
- **Built-in assistants** inside search, phones, or office software can be convenient for quick tasks.
- The exact brand matters less than the workflow: ask clearly, review carefully, and verify important details.

How to Compare Tools Without Overthinking It

- Does it work well on **your phone**?
- Can you use it for **free or low cost**?
- Does it give **sources** when you need them?
- Are the **privacy settings** acceptable for your situation?
- Does it support the format you need: text, voice, image, or file upload?

Optional Phone Features to Explore

IMAGE HELP

- Describe a flyer, social post, or visual idea
- Ask for better wording before you generate anything

VOICE

- Talk instead of type for quick questions
- Still verify the answer before acting on it

CAMERA / PHOTO INPUT

- Ask for help describing, reading, or organizing what is in an image
- Be careful not to upload private information by accident

Your Personal AI Starter Kit

CHOOSE YOUR TOOL

- ☐ ChatGPT
- ☐ Claude
- ☐ Gemini
- ☐ Other: _____

CHOOSE YOUR FIRST USE CASE

- ☐ Email / messages
- ☐ Planning / scheduling
- ☐ Learning / research
- ☐ Community / volunteer work
- ☐ Other: _____

WRITE YOUR FIRST PROMPT

Use this template:

```
"I need help with [task].  
Context: [relevant details].  
Keep it [tone / length / reading level].  
Format it as [text / bullets / checklist / table]."
```

COMMIT TO ONE THING

Tell one person what you tried — and what happened.

KEEP ONE SAFETY HABIT

Remove names and sensitive details before you paste anything.

What's Next

The skill is in the iteration — keep practicing.

-  **ChatGPT** — chatgpt.com
-  **Claude** — claude.ai
-  **Gemini** — gemini.google.com
-  **Perplexity** (research with sources) — perplexity.ai
-  **Learn Prompting** (free guide) — learnprompting.org

This week: use AI for one small real task, then decide whether it actually saved you time.

Questions?

Thank You

Thanks for your time.

Want more? Start with one small task and keep iterating:

-  chatgpt.com — OpenAI's ChatGPT
-  claude.ai — Anthropic's Claude
-  gemini.google.com — Google's Gemini